Roots and reductive groups of rank one

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October 2026

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Online course: https://kokunoyumeto.github.io/open-math-courses/courses/AG-RG/.

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Lesson 3

Roots and reductive groups of rank one

Written by GPT-6.1 Sol (OpenAI) in Codex, Ultra setting, October 2026. Self-checked by the writing AI, GPT-6.1 Sol (OpenAI). Original text: public domain (CC0). The normalization lemma in Section 5 follows the Stacks Project's proof, cited at the end.

The diagonal entries of a matrix act on its off-diagonal entries through ratios. Those ratios are the roots of a general linear group. For an arbitrary reductive group, roots are still characters of a maximal torus, but their one-dimensional spaces need not be globally trivial over the base. This lesson constructs the corresponding groups without using a power-series exponential, and shows why every root carries a copy of the rank-one geometry of SL_2.

We use torus conjugacy, torus deformation, and the centralizer theorem from the preceding two lessons. A reductive S-group is smooth affine of finite presentation with connected reductive geometric fibres. A semisimple S-group has semisimple geometric fibres. Statements about line bundles and subgroup schemes are made over arbitrary schemes, including nonreduced ones.

1. The centre and the two ranks

Let T be a split maximal torus of G, and, on an open set where the ranks are constant, write

$$\mathfrak{g} = \mathfrak{t} \oplus \bigoplus_{\alpha \in \Phi} \mathfrak{g}_\alpha.$$

For now Φ means the nonzero weights; we will prove that they form a reduced root system. Put

$$Z = \bigcap_{\alpha \in \Phi} \ker(\alpha : T \to \mathbf{G}_m).$$

The group Z is of multiplicative type. It is precisely the scheme-theoretic centre of G. Indeed, its conjugation action on $\mathfrak{g}$ is trivial. Exactness of invariants for a multiplicative-type group makes $C_G(Z)$ smooth with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}$. Its geometric fibres are therefore all of G; the smooth fibrewise isomorphism argument of the preceding lesson gives $C_G(Z) = G$. Conversely any central point belongs to $C_G(T) = T$ and acts trivially on every weight summand, hence lies in Z. These constructions agree on overlaps and descend when T is only étale locally split.

The centre need not be smooth: $Z(\mathrm{SL}_n) = \mu_n$, including when the characteristic divides n. Its largest subtorus is called the **radical**, denoted $\mathrm{Rad}(G)$. For a group of multiplicative type with character sheaf M, this subtorus has character sheaf M/M_{tors}. Thus its rank is locally constant

and its formation commutes with base change. The **rank** of G is the dimension of a maximal torus; its **semisimple rank** is

$$\operatorname{rank}(G) - \dim \operatorname{Rad}(G).$$

Over an algebraically closed field, the radical also equals the largest smooth connected solvable normal subgroup. Its unipotent radical is normal in G and is trivial by reductivity, so it is a torus; rigidity of torus automorphisms makes it central. Conversely a central torus is connected solvable normal. The quotient by this torus is semisimple: the inverse image of a connected solvable normal subgroup of the quotient would enlarge the radical.

The derived group will be constructed for arbitrary bases after the pinned existence theorem in Pinnings and the classification of split reductive groups. It is semisimple and the multiplication map

$$\operatorname{Rad}(G) \times G_{\mathrm{der}} \longrightarrow G$$

is a central isogeny. Its construction uses the root groups established here. We do not assume a relative derived group in constructing these groups. Central quotients are constructed by graded invariant algebras in Theorem 1.1 below, without using coroots. In rank one we will construct the simply connected cover explicitly below.

Central quotients before the rank-one argument

The rank-one argument below needs the affine quotient even when the centre is not smooth. The invariant-algebra construction is independent of coroots and root groups.

Theorem 1.1 (affine central quotient). Let G be a reductive group over a scheme S, and let $H \subset Z(G)$ be a closed subgroup of multiplicative type of finite presentation. The fppf quotient G/H is an affine reductive S-group. Formation of the quotient commutes with arbitrary base change.

Proof. Work étale locally on $S = \operatorname{Spec} R$, with $H = D_R(M)$. Its character group M is finitely generated. Right translation gives a grading $A = \Gamma(G, \mathcal{O}_G) = \bigoplus_{m \in M} A_m$. Put $B = A_0$ and $Q = \operatorname{Spec} B$. Invariants commute with any base change because they are a direct grading summand. The same summand proves that B is flat over R.

We check finite presentation. The data descend to a finitely generated $\mathbf{Z}$-algebra, including the smooth group, the closed embedding of $D(M)$, and centrality; all are finite-presentation equations. We may therefore assume R Noetherian. Choose finitely many homogeneous generators of A as an R-algebra and a graded surjection $P = R[z_1, \dots, z_n] \to A$. Its invariant part surjects onto B. The monomials of weight zero in P are finitely generated as a semigroup: their indecomposable exponent vectors form an antichain in $\mathbf{N}^n$, since if $u \le v$ are two such vectors, $v - u$ also has weight zero. Every antichain is finite. The latter assertion follows inductively on n by extracting a nondecreasing subsequence of the first coordinates from any infinite sequence, then applying the induction to the remaining coordinates. Every zero-weight vector is a sum of indecomposables by induction on its coordinate sum. Thus P_0, and then B, are finitely generated. They are finitely presented over Noetherian R. Descent and base change now give finite presentation in general.

Next we prove that $q : G \to Q$ is an H-torsor. First suppose $R = k$ is algebraically closed. The closed embedding $H \hookrightarrow G$ gives a graded surjection $A \to k[M]$. For each of finitely many generators m_i of M, choose elements $a_i \in A_{m_i}$ and $b_i \in A_{-m_i}$ restricting to the corresponding characters of H. Then $f = \prod_i a_i b_i \in B$ has value one at the identity. In A_f, every a_i and b_i is a unit. Each homogeneous component is therefore a free rank-one B_f-module generated by a homogeneous unit; multiplication of components is an isomorphism. Explicitly the map

$$A_f \otimes_{B_f} A_f \longrightarrow A_f \otimes_k k[M], \qquad a \otimes c_m \longmapsto ac_m \otimes e_m$$

is an isomorphism: for a homogeneous unit u_m its inverse sends $a \otimes e_m$ to $au_m^{-1} \otimes u_m$. Also $A_f = \bigoplus_m B_f u_m$ is faithfully flat over B_f. This proves the torsor assertion on $D(f)$.

Left translation by $g \in G(k)$ preserves the grading and gives the same proof on $D(f_g)$, where $f_g(x) = f(g^{-1}x)$. These opens cover Q. Indeed $B \hookrightarrow A$ has a B-linear retraction, so $A \otimes_B \kappa(y)$ is nonzero for every prime y of B and q is surjective. A closed point of Q has a k-point g above it, and $f_g(g) = 1$. Since Q is of finite type over k, an uncovered nonempty closed subset would contain a closed point. Hence there is no uncovered point.

Return to general R. Both G and Q are flat of finite presentation over R, and the geometric-fibre morphisms are faithfully flat torsors by the preceding calculation. The fibre criterion for flatness gives that q is flat and of finite presentation; it is surjective by the invariant retraction. The natural morphism $G \times H \to G \times_Q G$ is an isomorphism on geometric fibres. Both sides are flat of finite presentation over R. The fibre criterion applied to this morphism makes it étale, and its fibrewise bijectivity makes it an isomorphism. Thus q is an fppf torsor. Centrality permits multiplication and inversion to descend, making Q a group; this also identifies Q with the fppf quotient.

Its geometric fibres are smooth connected reductive groups. Here is a proof of smoothness and reductivity that does not assume a quotient theorem. Over an algebraically closed field, A is a normal domain, and its invariant subring B is normal: an element of $\operatorname{Frac} B$ integral over B is integral over A, hence in A, and is invariant, hence in B. A finite-type normal group over a perfect field has a nonempty smooth open subset; translation carries a smooth point to every closed point, so it is smooth. It is connected because $G \to Q$ is surjective. If its smooth connected unipotent radical were nontrivial, its inverse image would be a solvable normal subgroup of G. The reduced identity component of that inverse image is smooth, connected, solvable and normal, so is a central torus by reductivity. It surjects onto the radical: the finitely many components of the inverse image cannot map onto a connected group with the identity component having smaller dimension. A torus has trivial image in a unipotent group, a contradiction. Flatness, finite presentation and these smooth geometric fibres prove smoothness of Q/S.

□

2. Why rank one has only two moving directions

We first prove the geometric rank-one statement, rather than assuming a root classification. Work over an algebraically closed field k.

Lemma 2.1. If a torus acts linearly on an irreducible projective variety X, it has at least $\dim X + 1$ fixed points.

Proof. Put $d = \dim X$ and let T be the acting torus. Since k is algebraically closed, an étale splitting cover of T has a k-point: take a nonempty finite-type affine chart and apply the earlier Nullstellensatz. Pulling the splitting back along this point gives $T \simeq \mathbf{G}_m^r$. The weight decomposition proved in the preceding lesson, *Diagonal actions and their descent*, applies to the finite-dimensional representation defining the linear action. Choose homogeneous coordinates in which the action on points has the form

$$t \cdot [c_0 : \cdots : c_N] = [\chi_0(t)c_0 : \cdots : \chi_N(t)c_N], \qquad \chi_j \in X^*(T) = \mathbf{Z}^r.$$

Delete any coordinates vanishing identically on X, thereby restricting to an invariant projective linear subspace.

Here is an explicit cocharacter separating all distinct characters in this finite list. If $r > 0$, write

$\chi = (a_1, \ldots, a_r)$. For distinct characters χ, ψ, the integer polynomial

$$\sum_{i=1}^{r} (a_i - b_i) M^{i-1}$$

is nonzero. The polynomial root bound proved in S02 Lemma 4.A, applied over $\mathbf{Q}$, makes its set of integer roots finite. Choose a positive integer M outside the union of these finitely many sets and put

$$\lambda(u) = (u, u^M, \ldots, u^{M^{r-1}}) : \mathbf{G}_m \longrightarrow T.$$

The integers $w_j = \langle \chi_j, \lambda \rangle$ are equal only for equal characters. For $r = 0$, the unique cocharacter has this property since there is only the trivial character. Reorder the coordinates so that w_0 is minimal. By the deletion step, c_0 does not vanish identically on X. The coordinate hyperplane $H = V(c_0)$ is T-invariant.

We induct on d. For $d = 0$, the reduced irreducible finite-type X has one point. An affine neighborhood is a zero-dimensional domain, hence a field; the Nullstellensatz makes it k. Thus $X = \operatorname{Spec} k$, and its point is fixed.

Suppose $d > 0$. The section $X \cap H$ is nonempty. Otherwise X would be closed in the affine complement of H and hence affine. S01 Theorem 8.4 and its closed-immersion cohomology calculation prove that $H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is finite-dimensional over k. It is a domain because X is integral. Multiplication by a nonzero element is an injective endomorphism of a finite-dimensional vector space and therefore surjective, so this algebra is a field. Algebraic closedness makes it k. Affineness would then give $X = \operatorname{Spec} k$, contradicting $d > 0$.

Every irreducible component of $X \cap H$, with its reduced structure, has dimension $d - 1$. To check the dimension rather than assume it, take a standard projective affine chart meeting the component and intersect it with X. Its algebra A is a finite-type domain of dimension d, by the function-field dimension formula in AG-CA *Krull dimension and Noether normalization*, Theorem 4.2. In a local frame the hyperplane section is defined by a nonzero element $f \in A$; its component corresponds to a prime $\mathfrak{p}$ minimal over (f). This prime is nonzero. The principal ideal theorem in AG-CA *Dimension theory of Noetherian local rings*, Theorem 3.1, gives $\operatorname{ht} \mathfrak{p} \leq 1$, while $(0) \subsetneq \mathfrak{p}$ gives the reverse inequality. The height formula, Theorem 4.3 of the former lesson, yields

$$\dim(A/\mathfrak{p}) = \dim A - \operatorname{ht} \mathfrak{p} = d - 1.$$

Passing between nonempty affine opens of this integral component preserves its function field and hence its dimension by that same Theorem 4.2.

Choose one such reduced component Y. It is T-stable. Indeed, $T \times Y$ is integral: on affine charts of Y its algebra is the domain $A[t_1^{\pm 1}, \ldots, t_r^{\pm 1}]$, and these charts have nonempty intersections. The closure of its image under the action is therefore irreducible, lies in $X \cap H$, and contains Y through the identity of T. Maximality of the irreducible component forces this closure to be Y. The action factors through its reduced structure, since pullbacks of its defining ideal vanish at every point of the reduced source and therefore vanish. The restriction is a linear action on the projective variety Y. Induction supplies at least d distinct T-fixed points in $Y \subset H$.

There is one more fixed point outside H. Choose $a \in (X \setminus H)(k)$, using the Nullstellensatz on this nonempty affine chart, and normalize its coordinates so that $c_0(a) = 1$. Its λ-orbit on the same chart has coordinates

$$c_j(\lambda(u)a) / c_0(\lambda(u)a) = u^{w_j - w_0} c_j(a), \qquad j > 0.$$

All exponents are nonnegative integers, so these polynomials define a morphism $\mathbf{A}^1_k \to \mathbf{P}^N_k \setminus H$. It lands in X: the equations of the closed affine subscheme $X \setminus H$ vanish after substitution in $k[u, u^{-1}]$, hence in its subring $k[u]$. At $u = 0$, every coordinate of weight greater than w_0 is zero; the remaining coordinates have character χ_0 by the separating property. Every element of T, over

every k-algebra, scales these remaining coordinates by the same unit $\chi_0(t)$. Thus the resulting projective point is T-fixed. Its zeroth coordinate is still one, so it lies outside H and differs from all d points obtained inside H. This proves the bound $d+1$. □

The curve duality used in rank one

Lemma (curve duality). If C is a smooth projective pure one-dimensional curve over a field k and L is invertible, then naturally

$$H^1(C,L)^* \simeq H^0(C,\Omega_{C/k}\otimes L^{-1}).$$

Proof. Embed $i : C \hookrightarrow P = \mathbf{P}^N_k$, and put $c = N-1$. The regular-immersion calculation in Projective cohomology and smooth affine models, Lemma 6.1, proves over the original field, including imperfect fields, that I/I^2 is locally free of rank c, that the ideal is locally generated by a regular sequence, and that

$$0 \longrightarrow I/I^2 \longrightarrow i^*\Omega_{P/k} \longrightarrow \Omega_{C/k} \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. Its proof first calculates at geometric closed points, then descends the conormal module and the exact Koszul complex by faithful field extension.

Dualizing that Koszul resolution, with a local frame of L, gives

$$\mathcal{E}xt^q_P(i_*L,\omega_P) = 0 \quad (q \neq c), \qquad \mathcal{E}xt^c_P(i_*L,\omega_P) = i_*(L^{-1}\otimes i^*\omega_P \otimes \det(I/I^2)^*).$$

Here $\omega_P = \det\Omega_{P/k} = \mathcal{O}_P(-N-1)$. Taking determinants of the conormal sequence identifies the sheaf in degree c with $i_*(L^{-1}\otimes\Omega_{C/k})$. The finite-cover Hom double complex written in S02 Theorem 6.2 has only this nonzero sheaf-Ext row, and therefore gives

$$\operatorname{Ext}^c_P(i_*L,\omega_P) = H^0(C, L^{-1}\otimes\Omega_{C/k}).$$

S02 Ambient Theorem 6.B proves projective-space duality by the monomial trace, a two-stage twist presentation and dimension shifting; it identifies the same Ext group with $H^{N-c}(P,i_*L)^* = H^1(C,L)^*$. Its trace sends the class of $T_0^{-1}\cdots T_N^{-1}$ to one. All the Koszul, determinant, finite-cover and trace comparisons are natural. This proves the asserted isomorphism. □

Lemma 2.2 (the curve argument). Over an algebraically closed field, a smooth projective curve dominated by $\mathbf{P}^1$ is isomorphic to $\mathbf{P}^1$.

Proof. Write C for the dominated curve. The dense image of the irreducible $\mathbf{P}^1_k$ is irreducible. Smoothness gives reducedness, so C is integral and connected. If domination is initially given by a rational map, the homogeneous-coordinate DVR extension in the earlier S03 Theorem 2.2 makes it a morphism. Thus the hypotheses of S02 Proposition 6.5 hold: its complete separable differential calculation and inseparable-subfield reduction prove $g = \dim_k H^1(C,\mathcal{O}_C) = 0$ in every characteristic. Its proof is earlier in the programme; no unproved external form of Lüroth's theorem is used.

We supply explicitly the concluding rational-function calculation from that proposition. Choose a closed point $q \in C(k)$, which exists by the earlier Nullstellensatz. S02 Lemma 6.3 proves $H^0(C,\mathcal{O}_C) = k$, divisor Euler characteristics, the canonical degree $\deg\Omega_{C/k} = 2g-2 = -2$, and vanishing for negative-degree line bundles. Its earlier Theorem 6.2 gives duality. For every integer $m \geq 0$, these results yield

$$H^1(C,\mathcal{O}_C(mq))^* = H^0(C,\Omega_{C/k}(-mq)) = 0, \qquad h^0(C,\mathcal{O}_C(mq)) = m+1.$$

The first vanishing uses degree $-2-m<0$; the second is the proved Euler characteristic formula with $g=0$.

Take x in $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(q))$ independent of the constants. In the divisor description of this sheaf, it is a rational function regular away from q with pole order at most one at q. It has a pole: otherwise it would be a global regular function and belong to k. Its pole order is therefore exactly one. The functions $1, x, \ldots, x^m$ belong to $H^0(C, \mathcal{O}_C(mq))$ and have distinct pole orders. A nonzero linear combination has the pole order of its highest nonzero power, since all coefficients lie in k and that term cannot be canceled by terms of smaller order. They are independent, and their number $m+1$ is the dimension just computed. They form a basis.

Let $h \in k(C)$ be any nonzero rational function. The earlier divisor proof shows that it has finitely many poles. List its poles $a_1, \ldots, a_r$ outside q. The function x is regular at each of them, and $x(a_i) \in k$. Each nonzero function $x - x(a_i)$ has positive valuation at a_i and no pole outside q. Choose integers $N_i \geq 0$ large enough that

$$P(x)h, \qquad P(T) = \prod_{i=1}^{r} (T - x(a_i))^{N_i},$$

has no pole outside q. Multiplying cannot introduce a pole at another such point. Its remaining pole order at q is finite, so the product is a section of $\mathcal{O}_C(mq)$ for some $m \geq 0$. By the basis calculation, it equals a polynomial $Q(x)$. The polynomial P is nonzero and x is transcendental over the algebraically closed k, so $P(x) \neq 0$. Consequently $h = Q(x)/P(x) \in k(x)$. The empty pole list gives $P = 1$, and the zero function is already in $k(x)$. Hence $k(C) = k(x)$.

This equality gives inverse rational maps between C and $\mathbf{P}^1_k$: on a nonempty affine chart, send its finitely many coordinate generators to their rational functions in the other function field and clear their denominators; their equations remain satisfied. Both targets are projective and both sources are smooth curves. The earlier S03 Theorem 2.2 extends these maps at every DVR by homogeneous coordinates. Their composites are the identity on the common function field and hence on a dense open. The closed-diagonal equalizer argument for the reduced integral sources makes the composites the identity everywhere. The resulting morphisms are inverse isomorphisms. This argument needs no degree formula for an unchecked inseparable map. □

Proposition 2.3. A semisimple group of rank one has exactly two Borel subgroups containing a maximal torus, its Borel quotient is $\mathbf{P}^1$, and the action on that quotient has image PGL_2 and kernel its centre.

Proof. Fix a maximal torus $T \subset B$ and put $X = G/B$. RG01 Lemma 2.1 supplies its linear equivariant projective embedding; the earlier quotient-smoothness proof in AG-GS, *Quotients and torsors*, Theorem 11.7 makes X smooth. It is integral, being reduced and the surjective image of the irreducible smooth connected G. RG02's complete torus-fixed-coset proof makes X^T a finite disjoint union of reduced k-points. Its following transitivity argument identifies this set with $N_G(T)/C_G(T)$. RG02 Theorem 2.1 gives $C_G(T) = T$, so this quotient acts faithfully on the rank-one character lattice $\mathbf{Z}$, whose automorphisms are precisely multiplication by 1 or -1. Hence X^T has at most two points. It has at least one, the coset B. If $\dim X = 0$, integrality and the Nullstellensatz make $X = \operatorname{Spec} k$, so the torsor stabilizer forces $G = B$, contradicting nontrivial semisimplicity. Lemma 2.1 now gives $|X^T| \geq \dim X + 1 \geq 2$. Therefore there are exactly two fixed points and $\dim X = 1$. The Borel-normalizer theorem already proved in RG02 identifies these with exactly two Borels containing T.

Let K be the schematic kernel of the action on X. It is the intersection of the conjugates of B. This retains the full kernel on every test algebra: in the equivariant projective embedding the fixed-point equations are the coordinate two-by-two minors. If they vanish on every constant k-point of the reduced X, each of their finitely many linearly independent scalar coefficients vanishes on every such point, hence vanishes identically by the Nullstellensatz. Thus these equations vanish after arbitrary scalar extension as well. Its reduced identity component is a smooth connected normal solvable subgroup, hence is trivial by semisimplicity. Normality here holds schematically: conjugation by the smooth connected G preserves that component, and its reduced source factors through its reduced structure, as in S08 Lemma G.4.1. Thus K is zero-dimensional. It is finite:

its affine algebra is Noetherian, has finitely many minimal primes, and in dimension zero they are maximal, with residue fields k. The nilradical is generated by finitely many nilpotent elements and hence is nilpotent, by the bound on monomial exponents. The reduced algebra is a finite product of copies of k; the successive nilradical quotients are finite modules over it. This gives a finite-dimensional algebra for K. A positive-dimensional Borel consequently has a nonconstant orbit map to X. Otherwise all its point orbits would be points, and density of rational points in the reduced $B \times X$ would make the action trivial schematically, contradicting $B \subset K$.

We supply the rational coordinates required for restricting such an orbit map to a line. For a smooth connected solvable group $B = U \rtimes T$, RG01 Lemma 2.B gives

$$U = U_0 \supset U_1 \supset \cdots \supset U_a = 1, \qquad U_i/U_{i+1} \simeq \mathbf{G}_a.$$

The quotients U/U_i are affine by the earlier normal affine-quotient proof, AG-GS, *Quotients and torsors*, Theorem 11.1d. Its Theorem 11.16 makes

$$U/U_{i+1} \longrightarrow U/U_i$$

a $\mathbf{G}_a$-torsor. That theorem uses left cosets; here all U_i are normal in U, so left and right cosets give the same quotient group and the same assertion. Every such torsor over an affine algebra has a section by the explicit vector-line module-descent calculation in RG01's solvable-structure proof: the translation cocycle descends $0 \to A \to E \to A \to 0$, and a lift of 1 gives the section. This calculation works over any affine A. Translation by a section identifies the torsor with its base times $\mathbf{A}^1$. Starting with $U/U_0 = 1$ and repeating gives $U \simeq \mathbf{A}^a$ as varieties. The torus is split over the algebraically closed field, by the splitting argument in Lemma 2.1. Thus

$$B \simeq \mathbf{A}^a \times \mathbf{G}_m^r, \qquad k(B) = k(z_1, \ldots, z_d), \quad d = a + r.$$

These are scheme coordinates; no assertion about abstract group coordinates is needed.

Choose a nonconstant orbit map $b \mapsto bx$ and a nonconstant $h \in k(X)$. The map is dominant because its image has positive dimension in the integral curve, so its pullback $f \in k(B)$ is nonconstant. Choose the least $j \geq 1$ for which $f \in k(z_1, \ldots, z_j)$. Then $f \notin k(z_1, \ldots, z_{j-1})$. Write, after clearing finitely many coefficient denominators,

$$f = P(z_j)/Q(z_j), \quad P = \sum_i A_i z_j^i, \quad Q = \sum_i B_i z_j^i, \quad A_i, B_i \in k[z_1, \ldots, z_{j-1}].$$

Some coefficient minor $A_i B_l - A_l B_i$ is nonzero. If they all vanished, choosing $B_l \neq 0$ would give $P = (A_l/B_l)Q$, contradicting the choice of j.

The inverse image of the domain where h is regular contains a nonempty principal open of our coordinate chart. Choose a nonzero polynomial F defining such an open, multiplying by torus coordinates to clear Laurent denominators if necessary. Viewed as a polynomial in z_j, it has a nonzero coefficient in the other variables. Specialize every other coordinate so that this coefficient, the selected minor, and all fixed torus coordinates stay nonzero. Such a specialization exists: their product is a nonzero polynomial over the infinite field k, and repeated use of the univariate root bound in S02 Lemma 4.A supplies a point where it does not vanish. For no remaining variables the product is already a nonzero scalar. On the resulting coordinate line, P/Q stays nonconstant and F does not vanish identically. If z_j is a torus coordinate, restrict also to $z_j \neq 0$. We have obtained a nonconstant rational map $\mathbf{A}^1 \dashrightarrow X$, since its composition with h is this nonconstant rational function. The explicit DVR extension calculation in S03 Theorem 2.2 extends it to $\mathbf{P}^1 \to X$. Lemma 2.2, which includes inseparable domination, identifies X with $\mathbf{P}^1$.

The natural map $\mathrm{PGL}_2 \to \mathrm{Aut}(\mathbf{P}^1)$ is an isomorphism on all test algebras. An automorphism sends $0, 1, \infty$ to three sections that remain pairwise disjoint on every fibre. Locally trivialize their quotient lines. A change of basis sends $0, \infty$ to the first and third; the two nonzero coordinates of the middle section are units, so diagonal scaling also sends 1 to it. For uniqueness, an automorphism fixing 0

and ∞ preserves both Cartier divisors. The ratio of its pulled-back coordinate to that coordinate is therefore an invertible regular function on all of $\mathbf{P}^1$. S01 Theorem 7.2 gives $H^0(\mathbf{P}^1_R, \mathcal{O}) = R$, so that ratio is a base unit. Fixing 1 makes it one. The local projective matrices consequently agree on overlaps and glue in the represented projective linear group. This proves the assertion even over rings with nilpotents.

The schematic image H of $G \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$ is smooth and connected, and the map onto it is faithfully flat, by AG-GS, *Group schemes over a field*, Proposition 5.8 and the perfect-field smoothness proof. Its kernel K is finite. Its torus image has dimension one, and maximal-torus conjugacy in RG01 conjugates it to the diagonal torus of PGL_2. If H were proper, it would have dimension at most two. In every characteristic, $\operatorname{Lie}\mathrm{PGL}_2 = \mathfrak{gl}_2/kI$ has the diagonal line of weight zero and two distinct root lines of weights $1, -1$ for the cocharacter represented by $\mathrm{diag}(t, 1)$. The T-stable Lie algebra of H contains the diagonal line and at most one root line. Choose that cocharacter or its inverse so that all its weights on $\operatorname{Lie} H$ are nonnegative. The general limit-subgroup proof already given in RG01 Lemma 3.3 makes $P_H(\lambda)$ smooth with this entire Lie algebra, hence of dimension $\dim H$. A closed subgroup of that dimension in the connected smooth H is all of H. But

$$P_H(\lambda) = H \cap P_{\mathrm{PGL}_2}(\lambda),$$

and the ambient limit subgroup is triangular. Thus H would be solvable. The finite group $K(k)$ is central in $G(k)$: each conjugation orbit is the image of the connected reduced G in a finite set and is the identity translate. Every $H(k)$-point lifts through the faithfully flat finite-type image map by the Nullstellensatz. Hence $G(k)$ is a central extension of a solvable group and is solvable. Its finite derived-word identities hold on the dense rational points of each reduced finite Cartesian power of G, so they hold schematically, making G solvable. This contradicts semisimplicity. Therefore $H = \mathrm{PGL}_2$.

In particular $\dim G = 3$. Since $\dim X = 1$, each of the two Borels B_+, B_- has dimension two and unipotent radical of dimension one. The one-dimensional unipotent classification proved in S03 Section 4 identifies each radical with $\mathbf{G}_a$. Its image has dimension one because the kernel is finite. Projection of the corresponding point stabilizer onto its diagonal torus gives a character of the radical, trivial by RG01 Lemma 2.A. Thus its reduced closed image lies in the ambient unipotent line; dimension one makes it that entire line. Its torus character α_+ or α_- is nonzero, since the induced diagonal-torus map is an isogeny and the ambient root character is nonzero. The normalizer element interchanging the two fixed points acts by inversion on T, so $\alpha_- = -\alpha_+$.

The Lie algebra of K lies in both $\mathfrak{b}_+$ and $\mathfrak{b}_-$. Their nonzero-weight lines have these distinct opposite characters, while the shared torus has weight zero. Thus $\operatorname{Lie} K$ has no vector in either unipotent root line. Each finite intersection $K \cap R_u(B_\pm)$ is torus-stable. Since $\alpha_\pm \neq 0$, its polynomial ideal is homogeneous for the distinct weights $i\alpha_\pm$, hence is (x^n) for some $n \geq 1$. The Hopf identity requires every intermediate binomial coefficient in $(X + Y)^n$ to vanish. In characteristic zero the coefficient n excludes $n > 1$. In characteristic p, write $n = p^e m$ with $p \nmid m$. If $m > 1$, the coefficient m of $X^{p^e} Y^{n-p^e}$ in $(X^{p^e} + Y^{p^e})^m$ is nonzero, a contradiction. Thus $n = p^e$. Any $n > 1$ gives nonzero tangent space at the identity, already excluded. Both intersections are therefore trivial. The image maps of the two radicals are faithfully flat with trivial kernel, hence isomorphisms onto the ambient unipotent subgroups, by their full torsor relations.

For a point of $B_+ \cap B_-$ over any test algebra, write it tu_+ by the solvable decomposition. Its image lies in the diagonal intersection of the two ambient point stabilizers, so the image of u_+ is trivial. The just-proved isomorphism gives $u_+ = 1$. Therefore $B_+ \cap B_- = T$ schematically and $K \subset T$. A finite normal multiplicative-type subgroup of a smooth connected group is central: over k it has a finite character group, and the earlier coefficient proof for diagonalizable groups represents its automorphisms by that finite constant étale character-automorphism group. The conjugation map from connected G to this discrete group has value the identity automorphism at the identity of G, hence is constant with that value as a scheme morphism. Thus $K \subset Z(G)$. Conversely $Z(G)$ maps to the centre of PGL_2, which is trivial schematically. Indeed a central automorphism of $\mathbf{P}^1$

commutes with the diagonal torus and preserves its fixed sections $0, \infty$; interchanging them would invert the universal torus parameter and cannot commute with it. It is therefore a scaling by a base unit, and commuting with every translation forces that unit to be one. Thus $Z(G) \subset K$, proving $K = Z(G)$ and every assertion. $\square$

For a reductive group of semisimple rank one, quotienting by its radical gives this situation. Its centre is the kernel of the resulting action on the same projective line. The two Borel unipotent radicals are still additive lines with opposite characters.

Now let α be any nonzero weight of a maximal torus of an arbitrary reductive k-group. Define the codimension-one torus

$$T_\alpha = (\ker \alpha)^0_{\mathrm{red}}.$$

The centralizer $G_\alpha = C_G(T_\alpha)$ is reductive by the preceding lesson. Its weights are precisely the weights of G that are rational multiples of α, since these and only these vanish on T_α. Its maximal central torus has codimension one in T: the nonzero characters on T/T_α span a rank-one lattice. Thus its semisimple rank is one. Proposition 2.3 proves

$$\Phi \cap \mathbf{Q}\alpha = \{\alpha, -\alpha\}, \qquad \dim \mathfrak{g}_\alpha = 1.$$

This proves both the reducedness along each root line and the one-dimensional root-space assertion without appealing to a general root-system classification.

3. Subgroups obtained by taking a limit

The definitions and full grading, smoothness, connectedness and open-cell proof for these subgroups are in Tori, maximal tori and their conjugacy, Lemma 3.3, an earlier lesson. In this lesson Lemma 3.1 denotes that already proved general lemma; it applies to every smooth affine group of finite presentation, without reductivity or a root classification.

For SL_2 and $\lambda(t) = \mathrm{diag}(t, t^{-1})$, conjugation sends $\begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$ to $\begin{pmatrix} a & t^2 b \\ t^{-2} c & d \end{pmatrix}$. Thus $P(\lambda)$ is upper triangular, $U(\lambda)$ is upper unipotent, and $L(\lambda)$ is diagonal. This calculation works in characteristic two because the group character t^2 remains nontrivial.

4. Root groups over the base

Let $T = D_S(M)$ be a split maximal torus. Locally the nonzero weights are a fixed finite set $\Phi \subset M$, and each $\mathfrak{g}_\alpha$ is a line bundle by Proposition 2.3 on geometric fibres. Define T_α by the torsion-free quotient of $M/\mathbf{Z}\alpha$. Then

$$G_\alpha = C_G(T_\alpha), \qquad \mathrm{Lie}(G_\alpha) = \mathfrak{t} \oplus \mathfrak{g}_\alpha \oplus \mathfrak{g}_{-\alpha}.$$

Choose a cocharacter λ of T with $n = \langle \alpha, \lambda \rangle > 0$, and set $U_\alpha = U_{G_\alpha}(\lambda)$. It is a smooth connected one-dimensional unipotent group, with Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}_\alpha$.

For a line bundle L, write $\mathbf{V}(L) = \mathrm{Spec}_S \mathrm{Sym}(L^*)$ for its additive group.

Theorem 4.1. There is a unique T-equivariant homomorphism

$$\exp_\alpha : \mathbf{V}(\mathfrak{g}_\alpha) \longrightarrow G$$

whose differential is the inclusion of the root line. It is a closed immersion, with image U_α, and commutes with every base change. Moreover

$$U_{-\alpha} \times T \times U_\alpha \longrightarrow G_\alpha$$

is an open immersion.

Proof. On U_α, $\mathbf{G}_m$ acts through t^n on each geometric fibre. Its subgroup μ_n acts trivially: the fixed subgroup is smooth by exactness of multiplicative-type invariants, and equals U_α on every geometric fibre, so equals it over S.

Étale locally choose a section σ of U_α disjoint from its identity. The orbit map $t \mapsto t.\sigma$ extends to $q : \mathbf{A}^1 \to U_\alpha$ with $q(0) = 1$. Since μ_n acts trivially on the target, the map factors through the invariant ring $R[x]^{\mu_n} = R[x^n]$ on an affine chart. Its factor $\bar{q} : \mathbf{A}^1 \to U_\alpha$ is an isomorphism on geometric fibres: there the original map is a nonzero scalar times t^n. The smooth fibrewise isomorphism criterion makes $\bar{q}$ an isomorphism over the base.

The quotient acting torus $\mathbf{G}_m/\mu_n$ gives ordinary scalar multiplication on the source. The transported group law is a polynomial $m(x, y)$ with

$$m(tx, ty) = tm(x, y), \quad m(x, 0) = x, \quad m(0, y) = y.$$

Homogeneity forces $m = ax + by$, and the identities force $a = b = 1$. Thus U_α is an additive line. Normalize the isomorphism by its differential to obtain $\exp_\alpha$. A scalar-equivariant polynomial map of an additive line is linear; if its differential is the identity it is the identity. This proves uniqueness and allows descent of the local construction.

An equivariant homomorphism with the required differential must factor through G_α, since T_α acts trivially on its source, and through $U_{G_\alpha}(\lambda)$, since its orbit limits to the identity. The same uniqueness therefore holds as a map into G. The open immersion follows from Lemma 3.1, with $L_{G_\alpha}(\lambda) = T$. □

The notation $\exp_\alpha$ denotes this algebraic map, not the analytic exponential series. No division by factorials occurs. A root-group parameterization $x_\alpha : \mathbf{G}_a \simeq U_\alpha$ is exactly a trivializing section of the root line.

Example 4.2. In GL_n, conjugation by $\mathrm{diag}(t_i)$ sends E_{ij} to $(t_i/t_j)E_{ij}$. Thus

$$\alpha_{ij} = e_i - e_j, \quad \mathfrak{g}_{\alpha_{ij}} = \mathcal{O}_S E_{ij}, \quad x_{ij}(u) = I + uE_{ij}.$$

Example 4.3. For a line bundle L on S, consider $G = \mathrm{SL}(\mathcal{O}_S \oplus L)$. It has the split torus acting by (t, t^{-1}) on the two summands. Its two root lines are L^{-1} and L. If L is nontrivial, its root groups are $\mathbf{V}(L^{-1})$ and $\mathbf{V}(L)$ and need not be globally isomorphic to $\mathbf{G}_a$. Having a split maximal torus is thus weaker than having globally parameterized root groups. The distinction disappears over a field.

5. A projective quotient and its rank-one form

We use the general algebraic-space tool proved before this lesson in Affine descent, Zariski Main and recognition of spaces, Theorems E8.1 and E9.1. The proof there includes the finite flat affine quotient, the off-diagonal induction, separated locally quasi-finite scheme effectivity, and relative integral closure with its étale base change. It applies over every base and on every test scheme.

Quasi-finite normalization lemma. Let S be a scheme and let $f : X \to Y$ be a quasi-finite separated morphism of algebraic spaces over S. Let Y' be the relative integral closure of Y in X.

Then the factorization $X \xrightarrow{f'} Y' \xrightarrow{\nu} Y$ has f' a quasi-compact open immersion and ν integral. In particular f is quasi-affine.

Proof. Theorem E9.1 of the preceding supporting lesson proves the full factorization, after Theorem E8.1 establishes recognition and Corollary E8.2 establishes representability on every scheme test. Its integral algebras are descended using the proved affine faithfully flat equalizer, and Corollary D4.3 supplies their étale base-change compatibility. Thus for every affine scheme $Z \to Y$, the pullback $Z \times_Y X$ is a quasi-compact open subscheme of the affine integral scheme $Z \times_Y Y'$. This is quasi-affineness. All these input proofs precede the present application in the programme. □

The relative integral closure retains nilpotents; a reduced normalization is not substituted for it. The full argument is in the preceding supporting lesson, rather than being delegated to a source citation.

The following construction will also be used for flag varieties. It makes explicit why a fibrewise projective quotient is a scheme, even before we have classified the group over the base.

A flat-source fibre criterion. A finitely presented closed immersion $Y \hookrightarrow Z$ over S, with Y flat over S, is an isomorphism if it is so on every geometric fibre. Locally write its ideal as $I \subset C$. Flatness of C/I makes $I \otimes k(s) \to C \otimes k(s)$ injective. Fibre equality makes this module zero. Since I is finitely generated as an ideal, Nakayama at every prime of C gives $I = 0$. No flatness assumption on Z is needed.

Formal separation and normalizers

We first justify identity-neighbourhood detection over bases with nilpotents, and then prove the full finite-jet normalizer assertion.

Formal separation lemma. Let R be Noetherian and let H/R be a smooth affine group of finite presentation with geometrically connected fibres. Write $C = \mathcal{O}(H)$ and let J be its augmentation ideal. Then

$$\bigcap_{n \geq 1} J^n = 0.$$

Proof. The entire affine smooth-field component proof of AG-RG-S02 Lemma 4.1 makes every geometric fibre integral. For a prime $\mathfrak{p} \subset R$, flatness embeds $C/\mathfrak{p}C$ into its generic fibre over the fraction field of $R/\mathfrak{p}$: multiplication by any nonzero base element stays injective. That generic fibre is integral by geometric connectedness and smoothness, so $C/\mathfrak{p}C$ is a domain. Its augmentation onto $R/\mathfrak{p}$ also shows that it is nonzero.

We give the prime-filtration argument used here. In any nonzero finite module over a Noetherian ring choose a maximal annihilator of a nonzero element. It is prime: if ab annihilates that element and b does not, the nonzero element obtained by multiplying by b has a larger annihilator unless a already belongs to the first annihilator. Insert this cyclic prime-annihilator submodule and repeat in the quotient. The ascending chain condition on submodules makes the process stop. Apply it to the finite R-module R and tensor its filtration with the flat C. Its factors are $C/\mathfrak{p}C$. For any $j \in J$, the element $1 - j$ has augmentation one in each factor, so is nonzero in that domain and acts injectively. Induction through the finite filtration makes it a nonzerodivisor on C.

The algebra C is Noetherian by the full Hilbert-basis calculation of AG-RG-S01 Lemma 1.3. Put $I = \bigcap_n J^n$. The complete Artin–Rees proof of AG-RG-S02 Lemma 1.1 gives $I = JI$ by applying it to the finite submodule $I \subset C$ and taking $n = c + 1$. With finite generators of I, write this equality as $v = Mv$, with entries of M in J. The adjugate identity gives $\det(1 - M)I = 0$, with $\det(1 - M) = 1 - j$ for a $j \in J$. The just-proved nonzerodivisor property gives $I = 0$. This proves the stated separation, including when R is nonreduced. □

Normalizer lemma. If H is a smooth closed subgroup with geometrically connected fibres of a smooth affine group K of finite presentation over any scheme S, then its scheme-theoretic normalizer is a closed subgroup of finite presentation in K. Its formation commutes with every base change.

Proof. First suppose $S = \operatorname{Spec} R$ is Noetherian. We justify the finite locally free identity neighbourhoods used for the equations. For a smooth affine group F/R with augmentation ideal J_F, the identity conormal bundle $J_F/J_F^2 = \operatorname{Lie}(F)^*$ is finite locally free. On a base neighbourhood where it is free of rank d, lift a basis to functions $y_1, \dots, y_d \in J_F$. They define $F \to \mathbf{A}^d_R$, sending the identity to zero and with invertible differential there. The complete differential proof of AG-RG-S02 Lemma 3.A makes it etale on a neighbourhood of that section. The full formal-etale lifting theorem of AG-FSE, *Infinitesimal lifting and invariance under thickenings*, Theorem 4.1, constructs its unique inverse on successive zero thickenings. At each step the kernel $(y)^n/(y)^{n+1}$ is square-zero; both composites are the identity by lifting uniqueness. The thickenings are supported on the identity and stay in the chosen etale neighbourhood. Hence, locally on the base,

$$\mathcal{O}(F)/J_F^{n+1} \simeq R[y_1, \dots, y_d]/(y_1, \dots, y_d)^{n+1}.$$

This proves finite local freeness of every identity neighbourhood and the intrinsic associated graded identity

$$\operatorname{gr}_{J_F} \mathcal{O}(F) = \operatorname{Sym}(\operatorname{Lie}(F)^*).$$

The monomial descriptions agree through the natural graded maps, so the latter identity is independent of coordinates and glues.

Apply this to K_n, H_n, the nth identity neighbourhoods of K, H. They are finite locally free schemes, without a claim that these thickenings are subgroup schemes. The closed immersion $H \subset K$ induces a surjection on augmentation ideals: lift a zero-augmentation function using the coordinate-algebra surjection. Thus its augmentation powers are also the induced powers, and $H_n = H \times_K K_n$. Conjugation preserves the identity and all these powers. It acts by invertible linear maps on the finite locally free coordinate module of K_n.

Write $D = \mathcal{O}(K)$ and choose finite generators f_i of the ideal of H. Restrict their universal conjugates to H_n, for conjugation by both g and g^{-1}. A section in $D \otimes_R \mathcal{O}(H_n)$ vanishes exactly when all its coefficients vanish: locally use a free basis, or globally a finite generating list of its projective dual. The dual and its evaluation commute with arbitrary base change by finite local freeness. These are finitely many equations in D and define the closed finite-presentation stabilizer $N_n \subset K$ of the closed subscheme $H_n \subset K_n$. They represent the stabilizer on every test ring, including nonflat and nonreduced tests. Its two conjugation conditions make it a subgroup.

Its ideals $L_n \subset D$ increase: preserving the $(n+1)$st thickening preserves the nth. Since D is Noetherian, their union is L_N at one finite index N. Over the universal Noetherian quotient $A = D/L_N$, both conjugation restrictions vanish on every identity neighbourhood of H_A. The formal separation proof above applies to the smooth geometrically connected H_A, so each restricted defining equation is zero in its whole coordinate algebra. Both conjugations therefore preserve the entire H_A. Pulling back these actual zero equations proves sufficiency over every R-algebra. Conversely an automorphism preserving H preserves its augmentation powers, giving necessity. Thus $N_K(H) = N_N$ as full scheme functors. This finite universal description proves arbitrary base change, rather than assuming that an infinite intersection commutes with it.

For an arbitrary affine base, first descend K, H simultaneously to a finitely generated $\mathbf{Z}$-algebra, retaining smoothness, the closed immersion and group-law identities by the complete smooth-model proof AG-RG-S02 Proposition 3.2. Then the entire connected-fibre model argument of its Theorem 4.5 enlarges that coefficient stage so that H has geometrically connected fibres; the already retained smoothness and finite identities of K survive that base change. No connectedness hypothesis is imposed on K. Apply the preceding universal Noetherian construction there. Its pullback represents the original normalizer on every test scheme. The unique represented subgroup identifications agree on overlaps and glue. This proves closedness, finite presentation and every asserted base change over the original S. □

Cohomology of a projective completion

The preceding supporting lesson Projective cohomology and smooth affine models, Theorem 2.3, proves the precise formal-functions statement used here. If A is Noetherian, X/A projective, F coherent and $I \subset A$, then

$$H^q(X,F)^{\wedge}_I \simeq \varprojlim_n H^q(X, F/I^nF).$$

Here is the mechanism of that written proof. Over the Rees algebra $B = \bigoplus I^n t^n$, the sheaf $\bigoplus I^n F$ is finite on the projective base change X_B; projective Serre finiteness therefore makes $\bigoplus H^q(X, I^nF)t^n$ finite over B. If $M^q = H^q(X,F)$, $J^q_n = \operatorname{im}(H^q(X,I^nF) \to M^q)$ and K^q_n is its kernel, finite homogeneous generators give constants a_q, b_q with

$$I^n M^q \subset J^q_n \subset I^{n-a_q} M^q, \qquad K^q_m \longrightarrow K^q_n = 0 \quad (m \geq n + b_q).$$

The sheaf exact sequence consequently gives

$$0 \longrightarrow M^q/J^q_n \longrightarrow H^q(X, F/I^nF) \longrightarrow K^{q+1}_n \longrightarrow 0.$$

Its compatible kernel coordinates vanish by the displayed transition bound; the remaining quotient filtration is cofinal with $I^n M^q$. This proves the inverse-limit comparison, without an unexplained exchange of cohomology and inverse limit.

S02 Lemmas 1.2–1.3 prove exact finite-module completion, Noetherianity and faithful flatness of local completion. Thus a finite module over a complete local Noetherian ring is complete. S02 Lemma 1.4 proves unique lifting of idempotents through nilpotent ideals, and Corollary 2.4 turns the compatible thickened idempotents into an actual section of a projective scheme. These are precisely the two completion operations in the quotient proof below.

Lemma 5.A (Grassmannians). The scheme $\mathrm{Gr}_d(V)$ of locally free rank-d quotients of a finite locally free V/S is smooth and projective, commutes with arbitrary base change, and its Plücker line bundle is $\det Q$, for its universal quotient Q.

Proof. Trivialize $V = \mathcal{O}^n$. On the open where columns I give a basis of a quotient, its unique normalized matrix has those columns equal to the identity and $d(n-d)$ free entries. A second basis J gives the transition $M_J = (M_I|_J)^{-1} M_I$. These open affine charts represent the quotient functor on all tests and glue. The determinant quotient $\bigwedge^d V \twoheadrightarrow \det Q$ defines the Plücker map to $\mathbf{P}(\bigwedge^d V)$, with the quotient convention. Over the target chart $p_I \neq 0$, the ratios of minors containing a single replacement of an identity column recover, with their determinant signs, every free matrix entry. The corresponding map of coordinate rings is surjective. These target charts cover the projective bundle, so the Plücker map is a closed immersion, and its $\mathcal{O}(1)$ pulls back to $\det Q$. The construction glues for general V and uses only invertible minors, hence works over nonreduced bases. The subbundle convention follows by dualizing. □

Projective homogeneous quotients

Lemma 5.1. Let H be a smooth closed subgroup with geometrically connected fibres of a smooth affine S-group K with geometrically connected fibres. Suppose $N_K(H) = H$, and suppose every geometric quotient $K_{\bar{s}}/H_{\bar{s}}$ is proper. Then the fppf quotient $X = K/H$ is a smooth projective S-scheme, locally on S. Its universal conjugate subgroup $\mathcal{H} \subset K_X$ supplies a canonical relatively ample line bundle $\det(\mathrm{Lie}\,\mathcal{H})^*$.

Proof. The claim is local on the base, so work on affine pieces with fixed smooth relative dimensions. If $\dim H = 0$, its connected smooth geometric fibres are the identity points. The identity section into H is an etale monomorphism by the entire differential and open-monomorphism proofs of AG-RG-S02 Lemma 3.A and AG-RG-S04 Lemma E7.2. It is surjective on geometric fibres and hence an isomorphism. Thus $H = 1$. Its normalizer is K, so the hypothesis gives $K = 1$ and

$X = S$. The asserted line bundle is then relatively ample through $\mathbf{P}(\mathcal{O}_S) = S$. We may treat the positive-dimensional pieces below.

The entire finite-model theorem of AG-RG-S02 Theorem 4.5 descends K, H and their finite equations to a finite-type Noetherian base S_0, retaining smoothness and geometrically connected fibres. The full normalizer theorem just proved commutes with every base change. The equality $N_K(H) = H$ descends at a later coefficient stage: both are finitely presented closed subschemes of the affine group, and equality of their finite ideal generators uses finitely many relation witnesses. Work on the open-and-closed model rank pieces for the finite locally free modules below. Their pullbacks cover the original base, so this introduces no additional hypothesis.

The complete free-action proof of AG-RG-S07 Corollary 8.3 constructs $X_0 = K_0/H_0$ as an algebraic space and the full H_0-torsor $K_0 \to X_0$, with every base change. Smoothness descends through that smooth cover by the earlier infinitesimal criterion; geometric connectedness follows from the surjective image of each connected $K_{\bar{s}}$. Local finite presentation descends on etale scheme charts by AG-RG-S07 Lemma 5.2, and quasi-compactness follows from the quasi-compact surjective source. The quotient is separated: the pullback of its diagonal to $K_0 \times K_0$ is the inverse image of the closed H_0 under $(g, g') \mapsto g^{-1}g'$. Apply the whole ideal/closed-immersion descent of AG-RG-S04 Corollary A3.2 on etale scheme charts. Thus X_0 is a separated finite-presentation space over S_0.

Choose the finite jet index $n \geq 1$ that detects the full normalizer on this model. The whole preceding coordinate proof makes $\mathcal{O}(K_n)$ and its quotient $\mathcal{O}(H_n)$ finite locally free. Their ranks are fixed on the pieces chosen above. Conjugation gives a section of the Grassmannian of quotients of $\mathcal{O}(K_n)$ of rank $\operatorname{rank} \mathcal{O}(H_n)$, with stabilizer exactly H. Its orbit map factors through the quotient sheaf. It is a monomorphism on all tests: lift two cosets locally to g_1, g_2; equality of their Grassmannian quotients says that $g_2^{-1}g_1$ stabilizes H_n, and the full stabilizer theorem puts this element in H. The cosets are equal. Thus we have a finite-type monomorphism

$$\theta : X_0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Gr}\,.$$

It is separated and quasi-finite. The full space recognition and normalization proofs of AG-RG-S04 Theorems E8.1–E9.1, as stated in the preceding quasi-finite normalization lemma, make X_0 a scheme. On each affine Grassmannian chart its pullback is an open subscheme of the represented affine integral closure; these scheme opens cover it.

We now construct the compactification needed below. The Grassmannian is qcqs and projective by the complete Lemma 5.A. The full scheme finite-factorization theorem AG-RG-S04 Theorem D7.1 applies to θ and gives

$$X_0 \hookrightarrow \overline{X}_0 \xrightarrow{\pi} \mathrm{Gr},$$

with first map a quasi-compact open immersion and π finite. The scheme $\overline{X}_0$ is proper over S_0: finite maps are finite type and separated on affine charts, and the integral closed-image calculation of AG-RG-S04 Lemma P0.4 proves universal closedness after every base change; the projective Grassmannian is proper by the earlier *Projective morphisms and Chow's lemma*, Theorem 1.1. Properness is preserved by composition. We use this constructed finite-over-projective compactification, and require no assertion that it is itself projective.

Let p be in the image of the original base in S_0. Its quotient fibre is proper: after an algebraically closed extension of a residue field of a point above p, it is the given proper geometric quotient. Properness descends under a field extension here directly. Finite type and separatedness are already known; for any base-change test and closed subset, its image becomes closed after the faithfully flat field cover. The images commute with that cover because nonempty field fibres remain nonempty under extension. The full fpqc quotient-topology proof of AG-RG-S04 Lemma A1.4 therefore makes the original image closed. This proves universal closedness on every test.

Localize S_0 at p and pass to its complete local Noetherian ring A, faithfully flat by the entire AG-RG-S02 Lemma 1.3. Write $X, \overline{X}, \mathrm{Gr}$ for these base changes. Its proper special fibre X_s is open and closed in $\overline{X}_s$: it is open by the constructed immersion, and its map to the separated $\overline{X}_s$

is proper by the closed-graph/projection argument, so its image is closed. It corresponds to an idempotent. The full nilpotent idempotent-lifting proof AG-RG-S02 Lemma 1.4 lifts it uniquely through all maximal-ideal thickenings of $\overline{X}$; local lifts glue by uniqueness.

Here formal functions is applied to an actual projective scheme. Put $F = \pi_* \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}}$ on Gr_A. This is coherent since π is finite and the target is Noetherian. On every affine target chart, the finite module quotient calculation gives

$$F/\mathfrak{m}_A^r F = \pi_{r*} \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_r}.$$

Finite pushforward also identifies their global sections. To apply projective-space finiteness precisely, take the Plucker closed immersion $i : \mathrm{Gr}_A \hookrightarrow \mathbf{P}_A^M$ supplied by Lemma 5.A. The sheaf $i_* F$ is coherent: on an affine target chart it is the same finite module, now over the ambient ring through its quotient. By the definition of pushforward, its global sections are $H^0(\mathrm{Gr}_A, F)$. Thus AG-RG-S01 Theorem 8.4, applied to $i_* F$ on $\mathbf{P}_A^M$, makes this module finite over A. The full completion and formal-functions proofs AG-RG-S02 Lemma 1.2 and Theorem 2.3 then give the canonical ring isomorphism

$$\Gamma(\overline{X}, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}}) = H^0(\mathrm{Gr}_A, F) \simeq \varprojlim_r \Gamma(\overline{X}_r, \mathcal{O}_{\overline{X}_r}).$$

It is multiplicative because each comparison is the restriction map of the finite algebra. Thus the compatible formal idempotents give an actual idempotent and a proper open-and-closed component $Z \subset \overline{X}$ with $Z_s = X_s$.

The closed subset $Z \setminus X$ has empty special fibre. Its image in the local base is closed by properness; any nonempty closed subset of a local spectrum contains its closed point, so this subset is empty. Hence $Z \subset X$. The image of $Z \to \operatorname{Spec} A$ is open by the whole flat-openness proof for its smooth restriction from X, and it contains the closed point. Any such open is the entire local spectrum. In every geometric fibre Z is now a nonempty open-and-closed subset of the connected $X_{\bar{s}}$, and is all of that fibre. The open immersion $Z \subset X$ is therefore surjective and is an isomorphism. This proves that X is proper over A.

The monomorphism θ_A to the separated Grassmannian is proper by its closed graph and the proper source projection. It is quasi-finite, so the whole AG-RG-S04 Corollary D7.3 makes it finite. A finite monomorphism is closed: on an affine target chart $R' \to B$ its field fibre algebra has dimension e, and its monomorphism diagonal gives $e^2 = e$, so it is zero or the residue field. The coordinate map is therefore fibrewise surjective. Its finite cokernel is zero by the complete local Nakayama proof in AG-RG-S01 Lemma 1.2. Thus the ring map is surjective. Consequently θ_A is a closed immersion.

Closed-immersion descent AG-RG-S04 Corollary A3.2 gives the same assertion over $\mathcal{O}_{S_0,p}$. The whole eventual-property proof of AG-MO-03 Theorem 4.2 spreads it to an open neighbourhood of p: the local spectrum is the inverse limit of principal neighbourhoods and these are the given finite-presentation models. The union of these neighbourhoods contains the entire image of the original base. Pulling back proves that its orbit map is a closed Grassmannian immersion locally on S. This proves the original scheme and projectivity assertion; no properness condition has been imposed on unrelated model fibres.

The canonical Plücker line and its exponent

The full Grassmannian proof in Lemma 5.A makes its Plücker line the determinant of the universal quotient. Its pullback here is $\det \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{H}_n)$, where $\mathcal{H}$ is the universal conjugate subgroup. The entire finite-jet coordinate argument above identifies the augmentation filtration quotients with $\mathrm{Sym}^i((\mathrm{Lie}\,\mathcal{H})^*)$ for $0 \le i \le n$. These are finite locally free; their short exact sequences split locally because the quotient is projective. An adapted basis proves multiplicativity of the determinant in such a sequence. Hence this line is

$$\bigotimes_{i=0}^{n} \det\bigl(\mathrm{Sym}^i((\mathrm{Lie}\,\mathcal{H})^*)\bigr).$$

We prove its exponent over every ring. For a rank-d free module the monomials of total degree i form a basis of its symmetric power. A diagonal matrix with entries $t_1, \dots, t_d$ has determinant on that power equal to

$$\prod_{a_1+\cdots+a_d=i} t_1^{a_1} \cdots t_d^{a_d} = (t_1 \cdots t_d)^{c_i}, \qquad c_i = \binom{i+d-1}{d}.$$

All coordinate exponent sums are equal by permuting the coordinates; their total is $i\binom{i+d-1}{d-1}$, since the separator-position bijection counts the weak compositions. Division of this integer identity by d gives the displayed binomial coefficient. For $i = 0$ the exponent is zero.

This determinant identity holds for every matrix, including in positive characteristic. Both sides are universal integer polynomials in its entries. We prove the density calculation used to compare them. For the monic degree-d characteristic polynomial χ, the Sylvester determinant is the determinant of

$$(u, v) \longmapsto u\chi + v\chi', \qquad \deg u \le d-2, \quad \deg v \le d-1,$$

with target the polynomials of degree at most $2d-2$. Both spaces have dimension $2d-1$; for $d = 1$ the first summand is zero. Over a characteristic-zero field this determinant is nonzero exactly when χ and χ' are coprime. If they are coprime, their Bezout identity makes $\chi \mid v$, and the degree bound gives $v = u = 0$. If a nonconstant h divides both, the pair $(\chi'/h, -\chi/h)$ is a nonzero kernel vector within those bounds. These are the full earlier polynomial division and Bezout calculations of AG-RG-S04 Lemma P0.4a. In an algebraic closure the factored derivative at a root is the product of its differences from the other roots, so coprimality is exactly distinct eigenvalues. A diagonal matrix with distinct integer entries makes this determinant nonzero, proving it is a nonzero polynomial. On that open, the eigenvectors form a basis by the whole AG-RG-S06 Section 0 argument, and conjugation reduces our determinant identity to the diagonal one. If its difference polynomial is g and this nonzero Sylvester polynomial is δ, then $g\delta$ vanishes at every field-valued matrix. The multivariable root bound makes it the zero polynomial; the polynomial domain and $\delta \neq 0$ give $g = 0$. Its integer coefficients are zero since $\mathbf{Z}$ injects into the characteristic-zero field. Specializing proves the universal identity over arbitrary rings. Applying it to the transition matrices gives the identity of line bundles

$$\det \mathcal{O}(\mathcal{H}_n) = \big(\det(\operatorname{Lie} \mathcal{H})^*\big)^c, \qquad c = \sum_{i=0}^{n} \binom{i+d-1}{d} > 0.$$

The inequality follows from $n \ge 1$ and its $i = 1$ summand equal to one, for $d > 0$.

This positive power is relatively very ample through the actual closed Plücker immersion. The line itself is relatively ample, with the defining section criterion verified directly. Work over an affine base piece trivializing the finite Plücker bundle, so L^c is the pullback of $\mathcal{O}(1)$ from a closed immersion into $\mathbf{P}^N$. Its coordinate nonvanishing opens are affine. At any point and inside any chosen open neighbourhood, choose a principal open $D(f)$ in one such affine chart contained in that neighbourhood, by the full affine principal-basis proof of AG-RG-S01 Section 2. Express f as a polynomial in the coordinate ratios and homogenize to a polynomial h of degree a. Multiplying h by that chart coordinate gives a global section of $L^{c(a+1)}$ whose nonvanishing locus is exactly this affine principal open. These loci form a basis, and all their exponents are positive. This is the entire ample-section criterion proved in AG-RG-S01 Sections 8–9, so L is relatively ample. The zero-dimensional case was treated at the start. All finite-jet quotients, character actions, determinants and quotient-sheaf identities commute with arbitrary base change. Their unique comparisons descend the canonical line and the stated quotient to the original base. □

The quotient proof is the complete earlier AG-RG-S07 Theorem 8.2 and Corollary 8.3. Recognition and the finite compactification use AG-RG-S04 Theorems E8.1–E9.1 and D7.1. Formal functions is used on the projective Grassmannian with its coherent finite algebra, by AG-RG-S02 Theorem 2.3. The scheme and ample-line arguments are written here under the original hypotheses.

A universal finite cohomology complex

Lemma (finite projective replacement). Let A be Noetherian and let C be a complex of flat A-modules concentrated in degrees $[a, b]$, with finite cohomology modules. There is a complex K of finite projective modules in $[a, b]$ and a quasi-isomorphism $K \to C$ that remains a quasi-isomorphism after tensoring with any A-module.

Proof. Construct a bounded-above complex P of finite free modules and a map $f : P \to C$, descending from degree b. Once the terms above j are chosen, its cone has terms

$$D^i = C^i \oplus P^{i+1}, \qquad d(c, p) = (d_C c + f(p), -d_P p).$$

Its cohomology is finite: the cone long exact sequence uses the finite cohomology of C and of the already chosen finite free portion of P. Choose finitely many cocycles (c_ℓ, p_ℓ) generating $H^j(D)$. Take P^j free on e_ℓ, and set $f(e_\ell) = c_\ell$, $d_P(e_\ell) = -p_\ell$. The cocycle equations give $d_P^2 = 0$ and $d_C f = f d_P$. In the new cone, $d(0, e_\ell) = (c_\ell, p_\ell)$, so this kills H^j without changing higher cohomology. Continue to the left. Each degree stabilizes, giving a quasi-isomorphism $P \to C$.

Its cone is acyclic, bounded above and flat termwise. Such a complex stays acyclic after every tensor: start at its last degree and descend through

$$0 \longrightarrow Z^i \longrightarrow D^i \longrightarrow Z^{i+1} \longrightarrow 0.$$

The quotient is flat; hence the kernel is flat and the sequence stays exact under tensor. Thus $H^i(P \otimes_A M) = H^i(C \otimes_A M)$ for every M.

Put $Q = \operatorname{coker}(P^{a-1} \to P^a)$. The left tail is a free resolution of Q, and

$$\operatorname{Tor}_1^A(Q, M) = H^{a-1}(P \otimes_A M) = 0$$

for every M, since $C \otimes_A M$ starts in degree a. The module Q is finitely presented, so it is flat and finite projective. Take $K^a = Q$ and $K^i = P^i$ for $a < i \leq b$. The map to C factors through Q because $C^{a-1} = 0$. Truncation preserves cohomology, and the same acyclic flat-cone argument proves the assertion after every tensor. □

Apply this to the finite section complex of a line bundle L_0 on a smooth projective scheme over a Noetherian ring A_0. Choose a finite affine cover. Separatedness makes its intersections affine, and S01 Sections 4–5 prove that its ordered section complex computes quasi-coherent cohomology. On each intersection the line bundle is a projective module over its chart algebra; smoothness makes that algebra A_0-flat, so every term is A_0-flat. S01 Theorem 8.4 and its closed-immersion passage prove that all cohomology modules are finite. Under every algebra base change, affine module-sheaf correspondence and localization, proved in S01 Section 2, identify the new section complex with its tensor product over A_0. The finite projective replacement just proved therefore computes the line bundle cohomology after every base change.

Sections in a vanishing family

Lemma (sections in a vanishing family). Let $f : X \to S$ be smooth and projective of finite presentation, and let L be an invertible sheaf on X. Suppose that $H^q(X_{\bar{s}}, L_{\bar{s}}) = 0$ for every geometric point $\bar{s}$ and every $q > 0$. Then f_*L is finite locally free, all its positive higher direct images vanish, and these statements commute with every base change. In particular the canonical map $g^* f_* L \to f'_* L'$ is an isomorphism for any $g : S' \to S$. The base may be nonreduced.

Proof. Work with $S = \operatorname{Spec} A$. Choose a projective embedding, a finite affine cover trivializing L, and finite affine covers of the pairwise and triple overlaps. Write A as the filtered union of its

finitely generated $\mathbf{Z}$-subalgebras. The embedding, chart opens and overlap maps descend at a finite stage by finite-presentation descent, Theorems 4.1–4.2. Retain the closed immersion, so the model X_0 is projective.

Retain smoothness at a finite stage by S02 Lemma 3.1 and Proposition 3.2. In a finite polynomial presentation, Lemma 3.0 identifies formal smoothness with a left inverse of the conormal differential map. The left inverse uses finitely many coefficients; its equations on the finitely many relation generators have finite polynomial witnesses. Descend these coefficients and witnesses to one stage. The same left inverse then proves formal smoothness there, and the retained finite presentation proves smoothness. Apply this on a finite affine cover, retaining the cover and the projective closed immersion by the finite-presentation limit proof. The line-bundle transition units, their inverses and the finitely many overlap and cocycle witnesses descend at the same stage, as in S02 Proposition 3.2. Gluing these descended transition units defines the invertible sheaf L_0 on the smooth projective model X_0/A_0.

The preceding finite-projective-replacement lemma gives a bounded finite projective complex K_0 such that

$$H^q(K_0 \otimes_{A_0} B) \simeq H^q(X_0 \times_{A_0} \operatorname{Spec} B, L_0 \otimes_{A_0} B)$$

for every A_0-algebra B, compatibly with the canonical comparison maps. Its proof uses the finite affine-cover complex and projective Serre finiteness; ordinary tensor of K_0 computes its derived tensor. This finite argument supplies the universal comparison before pullback to the original base.

Put $K = K_0 \otimes_{A_0} A$. Near any $s \in \operatorname{Spec} A$, trivialize its terms. Whenever a differential has an entry invertible at s, shrink the neighbourhood and perform row and column operations to put that entry in an identity block. The equation $d^2 = 0$ makes the adjacent differentials zero on that block, so it splits off a contractible pair $A \xrightarrow{1} A$. After finitely many cancellations, all remaining differential entries vanish in $\kappa(s)$. The remaining complex therefore has

$$K^q \otimes_A \kappa(s) = H^q(X_s, L_s).$$

For $q > 0$ the right side is zero by the hypothesis and field extension; for $q < 0$ it is zero because L_s is a sheaf. Thus every remaining free term except degree zero has rank zero and disappears on a neighbourhood of s. The degree-zero term is finite free. Every cancelled identity pair stays contractible after any tensor. The universal comparison consequently proves the direct-image assertions and every base-change assertion, including nonflat changes involving nilpotents. The canonical comparisons glue. Notice that vanishing was imposed only on the original family, not on unrelated fibres of its Noetherian model. □

Proposition 5.2. If G has trivial centre and geometric semisimple rank one, and has a split maximal torus T, then Zariski locally (G, T) is isomorphic to (PGL_2, D).

Proof. Its geometric fibres are PGL_2 by Proposition 2.3: the action on the projective line has trivial kernel. Choose a root α locally. It is an isomorphism $T \to \mathbf{G}_m$, as this is true on the character lattices of the geometric fibres. Put $B = P_G(\alpha^{-1})$. It is smooth and on each geometric fibre is an upper triangular Borel subgroup of PGL_2.

Its scheme-theoretic normalizer equals B. The normalizer lemma makes it closed of finite presentation and proves that its formation commutes with arbitrary base change. On geometric fibres the point stabilizer in $\mathbf{P}^1$ is self-normalizing. Infinitesimally, the bracket of a diagonal matrix class with the lower off-diagonal class is a nonzero lower off-diagonal class in every characteristic, so the normalizer has exactly the tangent space of B. It is therefore smooth and equals B on those fibres. The flat-source criterion above, applied with source B, proves the equality over the base without assuming the normalizer flat.

Lemma 5.1 makes $f : X = G/B \to S$ a smooth projective curve whose geometric fibres are $\mathbf{P}^1$, and

it has the section $e = 1B$. A section of a smooth relative curve is an effective Cartier divisor: étale coordinates at the section give one parameter cutting out its ideal, a nonzerodivisor because the coordinate algebra is flat over the polynomial chart. Put $L = \mathcal{O}_X(e)$; it has degree one on every geometric fibre. The sections-in-a-vanishing-family lemma applies to L, since $H^1(\mathbf{P}^1, \mathcal{O}(1)) = 0$, and gives $E = f_*L$ locally free of rank two, with arbitrary base change. The evaluation $f^*E \to L$ is surjective: its cokernel is finite locally, its geometric fibres vanish by generation of $\mathcal{O}(1)$, and local Nakayama kills that cokernel. With the quotient convention it defines $j : X \to \mathbf{P}(E)$, and $j_{\bar{s}}$ is the usual isomorphism given by the two sections of $\mathcal{O}(1)$. Both schemes are smooth over S, and the differential of j is an isomorphism on all geometric fibres, hence locally an isomorphism of their cotangent bundles. The étale differential criterion makes j étale. Its geometric fibres are isomorphisms, so it is universally injective and surjective; an étale universally injective morphism is an open immersion, and surjectivity makes it an isomorphism. Trivializing E Zariski locally now gives $G/B \simeq \mathbf{P}^1_S$.

The action now gives $G \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$, an isomorphism on every geometric fibre, hence an isomorphism over S. It carries B to the point stabilizer. Within that stabilizer the transporter taking its torus T to the diagonal torus is a $\mathbf{G}_m$-torsor: the stabilizer of the diagonal torus inside the upper triangular group is the diagonal torus. Such a torsor is the frame bundle of a line bundle and is Zariski locally trivial. This finishes the pairwise assertion. □

6. Splitting a central extension of the rank-one cover

We need an integral result, including characteristic two. The following splitting argument is due to Gabber; we give the argument for a separated commutative group scheme Z, which includes the multiplicative-type centres used here.

Theorem 6.1. Every fppf central extension

$$1 \longrightarrow Z \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow \mathrm{SL}_{2,S} \longrightarrow 1$$

has a unique homomorphic section.

Proof. In SL_2 use

$$x(u) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & u \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad y(v) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ v & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad h(t) = \mathrm{diag}(t, t^{-1}).$$

Let D', U', V' be their inverse images in E. A central extension of a commutative group has a commutator pairing on its quotient: changing a lift by an element of the central kernel does not change the commutator, and the identities for commutators make this pairing additive in each variable.

For D', the pairing $\mathbf{G}_m \times \mathbf{G}_m \to Z$ is trivial. Restrict the first argument to μ_n. The resulting pairing is killed by n in that argument, and the nth-power map is an fppf epimorphism in the second argument, so this restriction is trivial. The schemes μ_n are universally schematically dense in $\mathbf{G}_m$: distinct Laurent exponents remain distinct modulo sufficiently large n. Separatedness of Z makes the whole pairing trivial. Thus D' is commutative.

The conjugation action on E factors through SL_2, since Z is central. The commutator pairing on U' is invariant under simultaneous multiplication of its arguments by t^2. The square map is fppf surjective, so it is invariant under simultaneous multiplication by every unit. For given u, v, the morphism $a \mapsto c(au, av)$ from $\mathbf{A}^1$ to Z is constant on $\mathbf{G}_m$. Separatedness extends the equality to zero, where it is the identity. Hence $c(u, v) = 1$. Thus U' is commutative; the same argument proves it for V'.

We construct a unique D-equivariant section of $U' \to U$. Fppf locally choose a unit t with t^2-1 invertible and a lift $\tilde{h}$ of $h(t)$. Such choices exist: the open locus $t(t^2-1) \neq 0$ in an affine line is smooth surjective, and the extension is an fppf epimorphism. In the commutative group U', the endomorphism

$$\varphi(a) = \tilde{h}a\tilde{h}^{-1}a^{-1}$$

kills Z and induces multiplication by t^2-1 on $U = \mathbf{G}_a$. It therefore factors through a homomorphism $U \to U'$, which after division by t^2-1 is the required section. It is D-equivariant because D' is commutative. Uniqueness holds since any difference is a D-invariant homomorphism $U \to Z$: scalar invariance and the specialization from nonzero scalars to zero force it to vanish. Uniqueness descends these local sections. Obtain $x' : \mathbf{G}_a \to E$ and similarly y'.

Set

$$w'(t) = y'(-t^{-1})x'(t)y'(-t^{-1}), \qquad h'(t) = w'(t)w'(1)^{-1}.$$

Their images are $\begin{pmatrix} 0 & t \\ -t^{-1} & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ and $h(t)$. Thus $h'(t) \in D'$. Equivariance gives

$$h'(s)w'(t)h'(s)^{-1} = w'(s^2t).$$

Divide by the instance $t = 1$. Since D' is commutative, this gives $h'(t) = h'(s^2t)h'(s^2)^{-1}$. The square map being fppf surjective, h' is a homomorphism. Its definition then gives $h'(s)w'(t) = w'(st)$.

Substitute the expression for w' into this last equality and move the y' terms using $h'(s)y'(v)h'(s)^{-1} = y'(s^{-2}v)$. With $u = st$ and $v = (s-1)/(st)$, the result is

$$x'(u)y'(v) = y'\left(\frac{v}{1+uv}\right) h'(1+uv)x'\left(\frac{u}{1+uv}\right) \tag{1}$$

when u and $1+uv$ are units. The restriction that u be a unit can be removed. Fppf locally write $u = a+b$ with $a, b, 1+bv$ units; the open conditions on a choice of b omit only finitely many points of each geometric affine-line fibre. Apply (1) first to $x'(b)y'(v)$, then to $x'(a)y'(v/(1+bv))$. The second denominator is $(1+uv)/(1+bv)$. Moving the two resulting h' factors together leaves the y' parameter $v/(1+uv)$ and the x' parameter

$$\frac{a}{(1+bv)(1+uv)} + \frac{b}{1+bv} = \frac{u}{1+uv}.$$

This proves (1) in its full domain.

These identities, the additivity of x', y', the multiplicativity of h', and its two conjugation identities are exactly the multiplication rules on the open cell $\Omega = U_- D U_+$ of SL_2. Define a section there by

$$y(v)h(t)x(u) \longmapsto y'(v)h'(t)x'(u).$$

It is multiplicative whenever both factors and their product are in Ω: reorder their factors with (1). Write $s_\Omega : \Omega \to E$ for this cell section. For any test scheme $R \to S$ and finite list $g_1, \ldots, g_m \in \mathrm{SL}_2(R)$, the open

$$\Omega_R \cap \bigcap_i \Omega_R g_i^{-1}$$

is nonempty in every geometric fibre: a smooth geometrically connected group has integral geometric fibres, and finitely many dense opens have nonempty intersection. It is smooth and surjective over R; affine refinements therefore supply an fppf local point c with $c, cg_i \in \Omega$.

In particular, for one g, use the nonempty open

$$\Omega_R \cap \Omega_R^{-1} \cap \Omega_R g^{-1}.$$

Then $g = c^{-1}(cg)$ is a product of two points of Ω. Assign to a word in cell points the corresponding product of their s_Ω-values. This is independent of the word. For two words with the same endpoint g, choose c so that c and its translates by every partial product of both words lie in Ω. Successive cell multiplicativity says that multiplying either lifted word on the left by $s_\Omega(c)$ gives $s_\Omega(cg)$. Cancellation proves equality. In particular a word representing the identity has lift one; concatenation therefore respects multiplication and inverses. These word values agree after further fppf pullbacks, so descend through the sheaf property of E. They define a homomorphism of represented fppf sheaves, hence a scheme homomorphism $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to E$. Its composite with $E \to \mathrm{SL}_2$ is the identity on generating words. It is the required homomorphic section on all test schemes.

Finally any homomorphism $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to Z$ kills $x(u)$, since

$$[h(t), x(u)] = x((t^2 - 1)u),$$

and one may choose $t^2 - 1$ invertible fppf locally. It kills $y(v)$ similarly, and then $h(t) = w(t)w(1)^{-1}$. It kills the open cell, hence the group. The difference between two central sections is such a homomorphism, proving uniqueness. □

7. Coroots from multiplication

Theorem 7.1. For every root α there is a canonical coroot $\alpha^\vee : \mathbf{G}_m \to T$, with $\langle \alpha, \alpha^\vee \rangle = 2$. There is a canonical perfect pairing $\mathfrak{g}_\alpha \otimes \mathfrak{g}_{-\alpha} \to \mathcal{O}_S$ such that, writing its value as XY,

$$\exp_\alpha(X) \exp_{-\alpha}(Y) = \exp_{-\alpha}\left(\frac{Y}{1+XY}\right) \alpha^\vee(1+XY) \exp_\alpha\left(\frac{X}{1+XY}\right) \tag{2}$$

whenever $1 + XY$ is a unit. This unit condition is precisely membership in the open cell $U_{-\alpha} T U_\alpha$.

Proof. Work in G_α, whose scheme-theoretic centre is $Z = \ker \alpha \subset T$, by Section 1. Theorem 1.1 constructs $q : G_\alpha \to Q = G_\alpha/Z$ as an affine reductive quotient and an fppf Z-torsor, compatible with every base change. The torus quotient has character group $\mathbf{Z}\alpha \subset X^*(T)$, so $T/Z \simeq \mathbf{G}_m$ via the descended character α. It is a closed subgroup of Q: its pullback under q is $T \subset G_\alpha$, and closed immersions descend through the fppf torsor. On geometric fibres Proposition 2.3 identifies this quotient with PGL_2, so T/Z is a maximal torus.

The open cell $U_{-\alpha} T U_\alpha$ is right Z-stable; centrality makes Z act only on its torus coordinate. Its quotient is the open subscheme

$$U_{-\alpha} \times (T/Z) \times U_\alpha \subset Q,$$

as follows by invariant-open descent and the product torsor. At the identity this gives the two nonzero torus weights $\alpha, -\alpha$, with their root lines, in $\mathrm{Lie}\, Q$. The centre formula of Section 1, applied to $Q, T/Z$, is consequently $Z(Q) = \ker(\alpha : T/Z \to \mathbf{G}_m) = 1$, as a scheme over the original base. Proposition 5.2 therefore identifies the pair $Q, T/Z$, Zariski locally, with PGL_2 and its diagonal torus. Choose the identification so $\alpha(\mathrm{diag}(t, 1)) = t$.

Pull back $G_\alpha \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$ by $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$. Theorem 6.1 splits the resulting central extension by Z. The homomorphism $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to G_\alpha$ obtained from the splitting identifies its upper and lower unipotent groups with $U_\alpha, U_{-\alpha}$: the maps are equivariant, and their differentials on the root lines are isomorphisms, so Theorem 4.1 gives the assertion. The diagonal cocharacter therefore defines $\alpha^\vee$.

Direct multiplication gives

$$\begin{pmatrix}1 & x\\ 0 & 1\end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix}1 & 0\\ y & 1\end{pmatrix}=\begin{pmatrix}1 & 0\\ y/(1+xy) & 1\end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix}1+xy & 0\\ 0 & (1+xy)^{-1}\end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix}1 & x/(1+xy)\\ 0 & 1\end{pmatrix}.$$

The upper-left entry is a unit exactly when the product is in this open cell. It supplies (2), a perfect pairing of the two root lines, and $\alpha\circ\alpha^\vee(t)=t^2$.

The pairing and coroot are unique. In the adjoint quotient, comparing the upper-root parameter in (2) forces any alternative scalar in the pairing to be one; equality of open-cell coordinates then fixes the coroot on every unit $1+xy$, which ranges over all units by setting $y=1$. An alternative coroot in T with the same adjoint image could differ by a cocharacter into Z, but (2) fixes its actual torus component and eliminates that difference. Hence the constructions on different local identifications agree and descend. The same characterization proves base-change compatibility. □

For SL_2, use $T\simeq\mathbf{G}_m$ via $\mathrm{diag}(t,t^{-1})$. Its root is $\alpha(t)=t^2$, and $\alpha^\vee(t)=\mathrm{diag}(t,t^{-1})$. For PGL_2, parameterize its diagonal torus by the class of $\mathrm{diag}(t,1)$. Its root is $t\mapsto t$, and its coroot is the class of $\mathrm{diag}(t^2,1)$. In both cases the pairing is two, but the root and coroot occupy different sublattices.

For GL_2, the roots are e_1-e_2 and its negative, and the positive coroot is $t\mapsto\mathrm{diag}(t,t^{-1})$. These explicit formulas remain valid over $\mathbb{Z}$.

8. The three rank-one groups

A lattice calculation with pairing two

Lemma 8.A. Let X be a finite free abelian group of rank $r+1$. Let $a\in X$ and $b\in X^*=\mathrm{Hom}(X,\mathbf{Z})$ be nonzero and satisfy $b(a)=2$. Up to an isomorphism of X preserving this pair, exactly one of the following descriptions occurs:

1. $X=\mathbf{Z}e_0\oplus\mathbf{Z}^r$, $a=2e_0$, $b=e_0^*$.
2. $X=\mathbf{Z}e_0\oplus\mathbf{Z}^r$, $a=e_0$, $b=2e_0^*$.
3. $r\geq 1$, $X=\mathbf{Z}e_1\oplus\mathbf{Z}e_2\oplus\mathbf{Z}^{r-1}$, $a=e_1-e_2$, $b=e_1^*-e_2^*$.

In these formulas b is zero on the displayed extra summand.

Proof. Write $a=ma_0$ and $b=nb_0$, with a_0,b_0 primitive and $m,n>0$. Then

$$mn\,b_0(a_0)=2.$$

Consequently (m,n) is $(2,1)$, $(1,2)$, or $(1,1)$.

In the first case $b(a_0)=1$. Every $x\in X$ has the unique expression

$$x=b(x)a_0+\big(x-b(x)a_0\big),\qquad x-b(x)a_0\in\ker b.$$

Thus $X=\mathbf{Z}a_0\oplus\ker b$; choose a basis of the free kernel. This gives case 1. In the second case apply the same expression using $b_0(a)=1$. It gives case 2.

Suppose now that both a and b are primitive. Extend a to a basis $a,c_1,\dots,c_r$. At least one $b(c_i)$ is odd: otherwise every value of b, including $b(a)=2$, would be even, contradicting primitivity of b. Relabel so that $b(c_1)=2q+1$, and replace c_1 by c_1-qa. This is a basis operation and makes its value under b equal to one. Call the new vector c. Replace each remaining c_i by $c_i-b(c_i)c$; their values become zero. Finally set

$$e_1=c,\qquad e_2=c-a.$$

These replace the basis pair a, c by another unimodular basis pair. They satisfy $a = e_1 - e_2$, $b(e_1) = 1$ and $b(e_2) = -1$, giving case 3. If $r = 0$, both primitive elements would pair to ± 1, so this case cannot occur.

The divisibilities (m, n) of a and b are invariant under lattice isomorphisms. They distinguish all three cases. □

Extending a map from the rank-one cell

Lemma 8.B. Let K/S be a smooth group with geometrically connected fibres. Let $\Omega \subset K$ be a fibrewise dense open containing the identity. Let H/S be a group scheme. Suppose $f : \Omega \to H$ sends the identity to the identity and satisfies

$$f(xy) = f(x)f(y)$$

on the open where $x, y, xy \in \Omega$. Then f extends uniquely to a homomorphism $K \to H$.

Proof. A geometrically connected smooth algebraic group is geometrically irreducible: its regular irreducible components are disjoint and open, so connectedness leaves only one. For any test scheme $R \to S$ and any finite list $g_1, \dots, g_d \in K(R)$, the open

$$\Omega_R \cap \bigcap_{i=1}^{d} \Omega_R g_i^{-1}$$

has a nonempty open in every geometric fibre of K_R. Its map to R is smooth and surjective. It therefore supplies a point c after an fppf cover of R, with c and all cg_i in the cell.

In particular, for $g \in K(R)$, choose $c \in \Omega_R \cap \Omega_R^{-1} \cap \Omega_R g^{-1}$ locally. Then $g = c^{-1}(cg)$ is a product of two cell points. Assign to any word in cell points the corresponding product of f-values.

This assignment is independent of the word. For two words $x_1 \cdots x_d$ and $y_1 \cdots y_e$ with the same endpoint g, choose c so that it and every translated partial product of both words lie in the cell. Repeatedly apply the given identity. The first image word multiplied on the left by $f(c)$, and the second image word multiplied by the same element, both equal $f(cg)$. Cancellation proves equality. The assignment also respects inverses: for $x \in \Omega(R)$, choose $d, d^{-1}, dx^{-1} \in \Omega$. The identities $(dx^{-1})x = d$ and $d^{-1}d = 1$ then give $f(d^{-1})f(dx^{-1}) = f(x)^{-1}$. The word $d^{-1}(dx^{-1})$ represents x^{-1}, as required.

The assignments agree after fppf pullback, so the sheaf property of H descends them. Concatenation of words proves multiplicativity. Yoneda makes this map of represented fppf sheaves a scheme morphism. Every extension must have these values on generating words, proving uniqueness. □

The three rank-one models

Theorem 8.1. A split reductive group of rank $r + 1$ and semisimple rank one over a field is isomorphic to exactly one of

$$\mathbf{G}_m^r \times \mathrm{SL}_2, \qquad \mathbf{G}_m^r \times \mathrm{PGL}_2, \qquad \mathbf{G}_m^{r-1} \times \mathrm{GL}_2 \quad (r \geq 1).$$

For a reductive group over a scheme with a split maximal torus and semisimple rank one, the same description holds Zariski locally on fixed-type loci. Trivial root lines with chosen frames give a global isomorphism to the corresponding base change from $\mathbf{Z}$.

Proof. The root and coroot construction in Theorem 7.1 gives two roots $\pm\alpha$, their additive root lines, the coroot $\eta = \alpha^\vee$, and $\langle \alpha, \eta \rangle = 2$. Apply Lemma 8.A to $X = X^*(T)$, $a = \alpha$, $b = \eta$. The

three resulting pairs are precisely those computed for the three displayed matrix groups: in SL_2 the root is twice the primitive character and the coroot is primitive; in PGL_2 the root is primitive and the coroot twice primitive; in GL_2 they are respectively $e_1 - e_2$ and $e_1^* - e_2^*$.

Let G_0 be the indicated matrix model. The lattice isomorphism gives a torus isomorphism $f_T : T \to T_0$ carrying root characters and coroots to those of the model. Choose a nonzero positive-root frame $E \in \mathfrak{g}_\alpha$. The perfect pairing of Theorem 7.1 gives a unique negative-root frame F with pairing one. Define $x(u) = \exp_\alpha(uE)$ and $y(v) = \exp_{-\alpha}(vF)$, and match these to the upper and lower matrix parameters x_0, y_0 of G_0.

The open cell theorem gives $\Omega = U_- T U_+$. On it define

$$f(y(v)tx(u)) = y_0(v) f_T(t) x_0(u).$$

This is an isomorphism of schemes from Ω to the model cell. The group law on the torus, the additivity of x, y, and the conjugation identities $tx(u)t^{-1} = x(\alpha(t)u)$, $ty(v)t^{-1} = y(\alpha(t)^{-1}v)$, agree under this map. The remaining multiplication rule is

$$x(u)y(v) = y\left(\frac{v}{1+uv}\right)\eta(1+uv)x\left(\frac{u}{1+uv}\right), \qquad 1+uv \in \mathcal{O}^\times,$$

proved in Theorem 7.1 by the arbitrary-base central-extension argument and the explicit 2×2 matrix identity.

For two cell points $y(v)tx(u)$ and $y(v')t'x(u')$, their product is in the cell exactly when $x(u)y(v')$ is: left multiplication by U_-T and right multiplication by TU_+ preserve the cell, as do their inverses. The preceding rule and its unit criterion therefore give every multiplication of cell points whose product remains in the cell. It follows that f satisfies Lemma 8.B. The lemma extends it to a group homomorphism $G \to G_0$. The inverse cell map satisfies the same identities and extends in the other direction. Uniqueness in the lemma makes their compositions the identity. Thus $G \simeq G_0$.

Any group isomorphism carries a maximal torus to a maximal torus. Over an algebraic closure the torus conjugacy theorem then identifies its root/coroot pair with the pair for the fixed torus. It can interchange the signs of both elements, but does not change either divisibility. The three invariant pairs $(2,1), (1,2), (1,1)$ distinguish the models in all characteristics, including characteristic two. This proves uniqueness without a forward reference to the derived group.

Over a scheme, restrict to an open where the root/coroot lattice pair is constant and the positive root line is trivial. Its paired negative line is then also trivial. The same torus map, cell formula and fppf word argument work over every test scheme, so give the asserted local isomorphism. When the lattice pair and frames are fixed globally, these constructions are global. All maps commute with base change because the displayed formulas and their character pairings do. □

9. Exercises and solutions

Exercise 9.1 (first steps). Compute all roots and root spaces of GL_n with respect to its diagonal torus. Determine the zero-weight space and the positive coroot for $e_i - e_j$.

Solution. The diagonal matrix units have weight zero and form $\mathfrak{t}$. For $i \neq j$, E_{ij} has weight $e_i - e_j$, each once. The corresponding root group is $I + uE_{ij}$. Its coroot has diagonal entries t in position i, t^{-1} in position j, and 1 elsewhere. Evaluating $e_i - e_j$ gives t^2, so the root–coroot pairing is two.

Exercise 9.2 (rank-one multiplication). Compute $U_{\pm\alpha}$ and $\alpha^\vee$ for SL_2. Verify the factorization (2), and explain why the character differential in characteristic two does not change this factorization.

Solution. The two groups are the upper and lower unipotent matrices. Their parameters are x, y in the displayed matrix identity, and $\alpha^\vee(t) = \mathrm{diag}(t, t^{-1})$. Multiplication of the three factors gives

$\begin{pmatrix} 1+xy & x \\ y & 1 \end{pmatrix}$, equal to $x_\alpha(x)x_{-\alpha}(y)$. The character on the upper group is t^2, so its pairing with this coroot is two. Although its differential is zero in characteristic two, the Laurent character and all polynomial matrix identities remain valid; no division by two was used.

Exercise 9.3 (infinitesimal information). In characteristic different from two, show that $\mathfrak{sl}_2 \simeq \mathfrak{pgl}_2$ as Lie algebras, while the groups are not isomorphic. What happens to the differential of $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$ in characteristic two?

Solution. The inclusion of trace-zero matrices followed by quotienting by scalar matrices has zero kernel when two is invertible: a trace-zero scalar is zero. Both Lie algebras have dimension three, so this bracket-preserving map is an isomorphism. The groups have different centres, μ_2 and 1. In characteristic two the scalar identity has trace zero and lies in the kernel of the differential, which therefore has one-dimensional kernel. It cannot be an isomorphism. The group map remains a central fppf isogeny with kernel μ_2.

Exercise 9.4 (classification). List the rank-two split reductive groups of semisimple rank one. Distinguish them by their centres and derived groups, including characteristic two.

Solution. Put $r = 1$ in Theorem 8.1. The list is $\mathbf{G}_m \times \mathrm{SL}_2$, $\mathbf{G}_m \times \mathrm{PGL}_2$, and GL_2. Their centres are respectively $\mathbf{G}_m \times \mu_2$, $\mathbf{G}_m$, and $\mathbf{G}_m$. The first centre is not a torus: in characteristic two it is nonsmooth, and otherwise it has two geometric components. We compute the indicated derived groups directly. Fppf locally choose t with $t^2 - 1$ invertible. The identities $[h(t), x(u)] = x((t^2-1)u)$ and $[h(t), y(v)] = y((t^{-2}-1)v)$ put both root groups of SL_2 in its commutator subgroup. The open cell word argument of Theorem 6.1 shows that these root groups generate SL_2 as an fppf sheaf, since $h(t) = w(t)w(1)^{-1}$. Their images generate PGL_2, because $\mathrm{SL}_2 \to \mathrm{PGL}_2$ is fppf surjective; hence its derived group is itself. For GL_2, determinant kills all commutators, and conjugation by $\mathrm{diag}(t, 1)$, with $t - 1$ invertible fppf locally, puts both determinant-one root groups in the commutator subgroup. The same generation argument gives its derived group SL_2. The central $\mathbf{G}_m$ factors contribute no commutators. Thus the last two models have derived groups PGL_2 and SL_2; the first and third have the same derived group but different centres. These computations are scheme-theoretic and remain valid in characteristic two.

Exercise 9.5 (families). For $G = \mathrm{SL}(\mathcal{O} \oplus L)$, identify the two root groups and their pairing. Give a condition on L necessary for a pinning of this pair with its displayed torus.

Solution. An upper off-diagonal entry is a map $L \to \mathcal{O}$, so its line is L^{-1}; a lower entry is a map $\mathcal{O} \to L$, so its line is L. Composition gives $L^{-1} \otimes L \to \mathcal{O}$, the perfect pairing in Theorem 7.1. A pinning chooses a nowhere-vanishing section in the simple root line. It therefore requires L^{-1}, equivalently L, to be trivial. This illustrates the global hypothesis absent from the field case.

The course prerequisite guide records the exact supporting statements, their full proof routes, and the hypotheses needed in their applications.

References and prerequisite proofs

- Brian Conrad, *Reductive group schemes*, §§2.3 and 4.1–4.3, for the dynamic approach and Gabber's central-extension splitting argument. The proofs above are written out independently.
- Milne's freely accessible *Algebraic Groups*, version 2.00 (2015). This exact free author edition provides comparison material; its citations do not replace the programme proofs.
- SGA 3, *Schémas en groupes*, Exposés XIX–XX, for roots and the relative rank-one theorem.
- The official Stacks project and AI Integrated Stacks Project, an edition with AI-proposed corrections and AI-written additions, not reviewed by the Stacks project's maintainers. The normalization lemma in Section 5 and its proof follow the Stacks project authors' argument (Tag 0ABS) in this edition.

The following supporting statements have their exact proof routes recorded in the course prerequisite guide:

- Algebra and sheaf cohomology before reductive groups, §§3–8: injectives, finite-cover comparisons, affine vanishing, projective-space twists, ample embeddings and projective Serre finiteness.
- Projective cohomology and smooth affine models, §§1–6: exact and faithful local completion; projective formal functions and idempotents; smooth connected affine models; universal finite projective complexes and all-base-change direct images; regular curve immersions, curve duality, divisor degrees and the genus-zero calculation.
- Completing a smooth affine curve and extending its group action, §§1–4: finite curve normalization, completion, the actual family action and one-dimensional unipotent identification used through the preceding solvable-group proofs.
- Affine descent, Zariski Main and recognition of spaces, Theorems E8.1–E9.1: recognition on every scheme test, representability and the full relative integral-closure factorization.
- Flat quotient bootstrap, Theorem 8.2 and Corollary 8.3: the algebraic-space quotient and torsor relation for the free smooth subgroup action, over arbitrary bases.
- Lemma 5.A of this lesson: quotient Grassmannian charts, arbitrary base change, and the closed Plücker immersion with determinant quotient bundle; the subbundle convention follows by dualizing.
- The current written group-scheme proofs: *Diagonalizable groups*, Theorems 3.4–3.5 and §4, for smooth fixed loci, invariant algebras and torus quotients; *Group schemes over a field*, Proposition 5.8, for the reduced schematic image and faithful-flat image factorization; *Lie algebras and smoothness*, Theorem 2.9 and Theorem 3.2, for the universal normalizer tangent calculation and geometric smoothness criterion; and *Quotients and torsors*, its affine descent proof and Theorem 8.1, for effective algebra descent and line-bundle frame torsors. These are the actual written proofs, including positive-characteristic and nonreduced scope, rather than source citations.

Theorem 1.1 proves the affine central quotient before the rank-one argument; the following lesson adds the consequences for root-group coordinates. The arbitrary-base derived group is constructed after the existence theorem in the following lesson.

History

This lesson's exposition, constructions, calculations, examples and solutions were written by GPT-6.1 Sol (OpenAI), Ultra setting, in October 2026, and are dedicated to the public domain under CC0.

The normalization lemma and its proof follow the Stacks authors' argument in *The Stacks Project*, *Morphisms of Algebraic Spaces*, Tag 0ABS, read through the AI Integrated Stacks Project English source edition on 1 October 2026 (versioned transparent source). AI Integrated Stacks Project contains AI-proposed corrections and AI-written additions and has not been reviewed by the Stacks project's maintainers. The Stacks Project itself is distributed under the GNU FDL 1.2 or later.